Bhakna , they were neither Sikh nor Punjabi. Their religion was patriotism.

Ghadar Party's ultimate goal was to overthrow British colonial rule in India by means of an armed revolution through the incitement of mutiny within the Indian army. It viewed the Congress-led mainstream movement for dominion status for India modest, and its constitutional methods soft. The mutiny was planned to start in Punjab , followed by Bengal and the rest of India.

Influenced by the Ghadar Party, around 3,000 Indian residents from the US and Canada, mostly Sikhs, sold their land, properties, businesses and homes and moved back to Punjab to participate in India's freedom struggle. Sohan Singh Bhakna (1870–1968) sailed to India at the outbreak of the First World War to organize and direct the rebellion. British intelligence was keeping a close watch on the revolutionary conspiracy and the movements of its leaders. The planned uprising in 1915 failed, and a number of revolutionaries were arrested and were subsequently tried. At Lahore, a special tribunal was constituted under the Defence of India Act 1915, and a total of 291 revolutionaries were put on trial. Of these, forty-two (including Sohna Singh Bhakna and Kartar Singh Sarabha) were awarded the death sentence, 114 sentenced to life imprisonment and ninety-three awarded varying terms of imprisonment. A number of these (including Bhakna, whose death sentence was commuted to life imprisonment and who was later released after serving sixteen years) were sent to the Cellular Jail in the Andaman . Forty-two defendants in the trial were acquitted.

In May 1917, eight members of the Ghadar Party were indicted by a federal grand jury on a charge of conspiracy to form a military enterprise against the United Kingdom. Their trial began in the district court of San Francisco and lasted from 20 November 1917 to 24 April 1918. The British authorities hoped the conviction would result in their deportation from the United States to India. However, strong local public support prevented the US Department of Justice from doing so.

The participation of thousands of Canada/US-returned Sikhs in the movement against British rule 'left a widespread mark in Punjab, its history and society and political evolution, even though